

THE FEDERAL POLYTECHNIC, MUBI

**QUESTION AND ANSWERS ON
DAF 111 – USE OF ENGLISH I**

**BY
JONES JAMES**

DEPARTMENT OF LANGUAGES AND COMMUNICATION

A COMMUNICATION

Q1 Define Communication

ANS:

The term communication is the process by which information is passed between individuals or organizations by means of previously agreed symbols.

Communication is the process of passing information from one place to another. It is an activity or process of expressing ideas, feelings or giving people information.

Q2 List and explain the process of communication

ANS:

Sender/encoder

Message

Channel

Receiver/decoder

Feedback

EXPLANATION:

SENDER: This refers to the person or group of persons who transmits the message to the receiver.

MESSAGE: This is the idea, information, behavior etc that is transmitted or the main theme of communication. It contains what the sender want the receiver to know.

CHANNEL: It refers to the medium through which communication flows.

RECEIVER/DECODER: The receiver is the person(s) to whom the message is directed to. It equally refers to the person who receives and interprets the message sent.

FEEDBACK: It refers to one's reaction to the message sent.

Q3 Explain the relationship between language and communication.

ANS:

Language is a necessary tool for communication. For communication to take place, there must be possession of common language or mutual intelligibility between the parties involved. So, when communicating there is need for the parties to share and understand common signs and symbols.

Q4 Explain code switching and code mixing in communicating

ANS:

Code switching is the process of using a particular language at first, then, in the course of discussion switches over to another language instantly. For example, a student may choose to use English language when the teacher is in the class but may switch to pidgin or Hausa, Yoruba or Igbo or to any local language when the teacher or lecturer is not there. In another hand, code mixing is the process of using two languages simultaneously. For example, “let us go to **Kasuwa ko**”. “I sabi say **you are coming to school tomorrow**”. “Ina zaka yi **spending** sallah **break** naka.

Q5 What is interference?

ANS:

Interference is the partial or wholesome transfer of the linguistic system of the learned mother tongue (Li) into those of the second language.

Q6 List three (3) levels where interference could take place and explain two (2)

ANS:

Interference could take place at the following levels:

- i. Phonological level
- ii. Syntactic level and at
- iii. Lexical level

EXPLANATION

PHONOLOGICAL LEVEL: This occurs as a result of differences in the sound in the sound structures of two languages. Many Nigerian speakers of English tend to transfer wholly the sound features of their mother tongue into the sound

characteristic that they generate in English. Sometimes, even without seeing them, one can easily identify the speaker as Yoruba speaker of English, Hausa Speaker or Igbo speaker of English.

A Yoruba speaker of English will say **Si** instead of **She**. Hausa speaker will say **fery** instead of **very** or **pipe** instead of **five**.

Generally, Nigerian users of English pronounce English sounds with Nigerian flavor. Example:

Tinkers instead of **Thinkers**.

Tank instead of **thank**

Does instead of **Those**

Faya instead of **fire**

Sukul instead of **school**

SYNTACTICAL LEVEL: Syntactical interference has to do with grammatical structure of the languages used. What is grammatical correct in one language could be grammatically wrong in another language as result of dissimilarity in the structures of the two languages. Cases of interference abound at this level. For example, in

(a) **Plurality:**

Nigerian	British
Luggages	Luggage
Properties (belongings)	Property
Loads	Load
Machineries	Machinery
New slangs	New Slang
Furnitures	Furniture
Informations	Information
Equipments	Equipment

(b) Adjectives example

- i. How long shall we survive on food importation (imported)
- ii. His behavior is very disgracing (disgraceful)
- iii. A matured girl will not dress like that.

REPETITION OF WORDS: Many Nigerians are often unnecessarily repeat words in their constructions or in speaking, even in writing. For example:

- i. Give them three three minutes = Give them three minutes each.
- ii. They asked us to pay ten ten naira = they asked us to pay ten naira each.
- iii. He is fond of carrying small small girls = he is fond of carrying little girls.

AT LEXICAL LEVEL: On the lexical or vocabulary level, interference may occur as a result of the wide range of divergence in collocation and the unlimited number of the vocabulary items involved in two languages. So, the tendency to transfer the items of one language to another is enormous. For example, a Nigerian users of English in referring to a piece of string would say **he tired a birthday present with a rope**. This is because what is expressed by various vocabulary or lexical items in English as in **rope** line **string** and card, is just one lexical item in some Nigerian languages.

Q7 List twelve barriers to effective communication and explain them.

ANS:

The barriers to effective communication are:

- i. Language barrier
- ii. Physical barrier
- iii. Lack of preparation
- iv. Ineffective feedback
- v. Inappropriate timing
- vi. Physiological barrier
- vii. Attitudinal barrier etc.

EXPLANATION

LANGUAGE BARRIER: This seems easy but even people speaking the same language can have difficulty in understanding each other if they are from different regions of the same country. Slangs, professional jargons can hurt communication with the best intention.

PHYSICAL BARRIER: This has to do with poor or outdated equipment used during communications, background noise, poor lighting, distance, static situation in radio or telephone transmission.

LACK OF PREPARATION: Talking or writing without proper preparation as regards to your purpose of communication and a good content of what you intend to pass across impair effective communication.

INAPPROPRIATE TIMING: Inappropriate timing of the delivery of the message could be a barrier to its being accepted or rejected.

Q8 List and explain the purposes for which human beings communicate.

ANS:

The purpose of communication are as follows:

- i. Dissemination of information: Human beings use communication for the purpose of giving information to others. It is through communication that we collect, process, store and send ideas, information, news, opinions and message.
- ii. Expression of feelings: Through communication, human beings express their feelings and desires. Without communication, it will be impossible for us to let out our strong emotions.
- iii. Imparting of knowledge: Human beings use communication to educate others. Acquisition of necessary skills, good character and development of individuals can only be achieved through communication.
- iv. Establishing relationship: Communication helps human beings to establish relationship with others. Effective communication within an organization brings progress and good relationship among members of the organization.
- v. Creating pleasure: Human beings communicate in order to create pleasure for others. Human beings communicate through signs,

symbols, dances, sport, music, art and mime, human beings entertain themselves to make life more meaningful.

B ORAL COMMUNICATION

Q9. List nine (9) organs of speech and explain four (4) only.

ANS:

The organs of speech are as follows:

- Upper and lower lips
- The lungs
- The teeth
- The alveolar ridge
- The tongue
- The vocal cords
- Pharynx
- The Nasal cavity
- The hard palate
- The Trachea
- Oesophagus etc.

EXPLANATION

- i. **THE TONGUE:** The tongue is the most essential and crucial organs of speech. It moves about in the mouth to produce various sounds as it articulate with other organs of speech. We normally consider the height of the tongue (whether high or low) in relation to the roof of the mouth and its position in terms of front or backward movement before naming a particular sound.
- ii. **THE LIPS:** The lips are also important in the production of sounds such as bilabial sounds example /p/ /b/ /m/ /w/
- iii. **THE ALVEOLAR RIDGE:** This is located between the hard palate and the upper teeth. It is the point where the tip of the tongue articulates with, to form or produce alveolar sounds. Example /t/ /d/ /i/ /n/.
- iv. **THE SOFT PALATE VELUM:** This can be found behind the hard palate. Velum is capable of being raised or lowered and at the extremity

of which is the UVULA. The back of the tongue articulates with the soft palate to produce VELAR sounds such as /k/ /g/ /D/ /q/.

A sound maybe oral or nasal depending on where the pulmonic air from the lungs passes out from. If the velum is raised to block the passage to the nasal cavity. The sounds that will be produced will be oral sounds. If however, the passage is not blocked, the sounds that will be produced will be nasal sounds such as in /m/ /n/ /D/.

- v. THE NASAL CAVITY: This is an open space behind the nose and above the palate where air passes through when we breath. The proper production of nasal sounds are made possible through the help of the cavity. The sounds such as /m/ /n/ /D/ are all nasalized sounds.
- vi. THE GLOTTIS: The place where the glottal sounds are produced is known as THE PHARYNX. Example the sound /h/.
- vii. THE VOCAL CORDS: These are the two folds of ligaments and elastic tissue found in the larynx (Adam's apple). In between the folds is an opening which is referred to as the GLOTTIS. If the opening is wide enough whereby the pulmonic air has a free passage, the cords will not vibrate and the sounds produced will be VOICELESS. On the other hand, if the opening is too small, the air will cause the cords to vibrate in the process of forcing its way out of the small opening. As a result of the vibration, VOICED SOUNDS will be produced.

Q10 Explain phonemes of English

ANS:

Phoneme is the smallest part of sound that is “significant” or distinctive. That is to say, it distinguishes one word from another. Each language has its own specific number of phonemes and uses them differently from any other language. They are normally regarded as consonants and vowel phonemes. The English language has 44 phonemes: 24 consonants and 20 vowels.

Q11 Supply one word each and underline the sound that contain each phonemes.

ANS:

/i/ sit lit hit

/p/ pin sleep pit

/b/ book because vibrate

/f/ laugh enough food defend

/g/ good bag girl

/i:/ peak seat

/θ/ thank think this

/ts/ match church cheep

/S/ Sugar Vision

/t/ mother father feather

Q12 Identify any five (5) organs of speech.

ANS:

The organs of speech are

- Upper and lower lips
- Tongue
- Teeth
- Lungs
- Vocal cord
- Nasal cavity
- Pharynx

Q13 List any ten (10) pure vowel sounds phonemes with examples.

ANS:

These are:

/i/ ? e.g. lit kid

/i:/ ?

/e/ ?

/æ/ ?

/ə/ ?

/ə:/ ?

/ɔ:/ ?

/ɒ/ ?

/ʊ:/ ?

/ʊ/ ?

/^/ ?

Q14 write short notes on the following:

- i. Syllable
- ii. Stress
- iii. Intonation
- iv. Monosyllabic
- v. Polysyllabic
- vi. Bisyllabic

ANS:

SYLLABLE: A syllable is a unit of a word or a word that you pronounce with single breath pulse. This means that when you pronounce syllable, air rushes out of your mouth once. If there is only one breath pulse. For instance, out-rushing of the air from your mouth once, then you have pronounced a syllable. Example: go, drink, walk, pen, kill, write, etc.

STRESS: This is extra energy in pronouncing a given syllable/as the degree of force with which a syllable is uttered.

INTONATION: This is the rising and falling of the voice in speech/variations in the level of pitch during speech.

MONOSYLLABIC: A word that has only one syllable is said to be monosyllabic example go, pen, kill, love, write etc.

POLYSYLLABIC: This refers to words that have three, four, five syllable. Example Comfortable, articulate, investigate, Reconcile.

BISYLLABIC: These are words which contain two syllables. If a word contains two syllables, only one of the syllables is stressed. Stress therefore, refers to the syllable that we pronounce with greater prominence.

RHYTHEME: This refers to a regular series of sound/the general movement of sounds in continuous speech.

BILABIAL: This refers to sounds produced between the upper and lower lips and the upper teeth. Example /f/, /v/.

C CORRESPONDENCE

Q15 Define correspondence

ANS:

Correspondence is the process of writing sending and receiving of messages between two people or organization.

Q16 Write short notes on the following:

- i. Circular
- ii. Memo
- iii. Letter
- iv. Email
- v. Notice

ANS:

CIRCULAR: This is a sort of letter sent to a larger number of people within an organization at the same time.

MEMO: Memo refers to a short note circulated within an organization or company. It cannot go outside a company or organization.

LETTER: This is a printed or written notes/message addressed to a person or group of persons or to an organization. The letter could be either formal, informal or semi-formal.

Email: This is a way to communication by computer i.e. to communicate electronically on the computer.

NOTICE: Notice is usually a written communicating information or warning.

Q17 What is Business Letter?

ANS:

Business letters are letters we write to organizations in form of application for Job, letter of invitation, writing confidential, post interview letters etc.

Q18 Compare and contrast the format of formal and informal letter.

ANS:

Formal letter	Informal letter
i. It has two address, that of the writer and receiver	i. Only one address of the writer/sender
ii. It has date	ii. It has date
iii. Salutation/dear sir	iii. Salutation/dearest etc
iv. The title/heading	iv. Not title/heading
v. Complimentary close, yours faithfully and the full name of the writer	v. Complimentary close/yours sincerely followed by first name/pet name
vi. Signature of the writer	vi. No signature
vii. Full name of the writer	vii. Writer's first name
viii. Designation of the writer	viii. No designation

Q19 List six (6) principal features of formal letter and briefly explain any two (2).

ANS:

The principal features of formal letter are as follows:

- i. Writer's address
- ii. Date
- iii. The recipient or receiver's address
- iv. The salutation/dear sir or dear madam
- v. The heading/title
- vi. The body
- vii. The complimentary close
- viii. Signature
- ix. Your appointment

EXPLANATION

Writer's address: It refers to the address of the writer which appears at the (top or head) of the letter. It consists of the stress/department, city, box, number, town etc.

The date: The date shows the exact time the letter was written.

The recipient address: This is the name and address of the organization or person to whom the letter is directed to.

Salutation: This is a formal greeting and it begins at the left hand margin.

The body: The body of the letter contains the message. It starts below salutation.

The complimentary close: This is the formal goodbye usually placed below the last line of the body. It begins at the centre of the page in the modified block format. Etc.

Q20 List the five (5) features of a Memo

ANS:

The features of a memo are:

- i. Date
- ii. Subject heading
- iii. Body
- iv. Writer's name
- v. From:
- vi. Ref:
- vii. To:

Q21 Logically, list the features of formal letter.

ANS:

Logically, the features of the formal letter are:

- i. Writer's address
- ii. Date
- iii. Receiver's address
- iv. Salutation
- v. Title/heading
- vi. The body
- vii. Complementary close
- viii. Signature
- ix. Writer's full name.

Q22 Explain the functions of the FIRST, MIDDLE and LAST paragraph.

ANS:

FIRST: First paragraph establishes the purpose of the letter and tells the reader what the letter is about i.e. it introduces the letter.

MIDDLE: Middle paragraph explains the subject of the letter and provide information.

LAST: Last paragraph summarizes the content of the letter.

Q23 What is a Memorandum/memo?

ANS:

Memorandum is an official note from one person to another. Memoranda (plural).

Q24 Define a letter

ANS:

A letter can be defined as a message that is written and sent to somebody.

Q25 List ten (10) types of Correspondence

ANS:

Types of Correspondence are:

Letter writing

Memo

Circular

Application

Condolence

Appreciation

Recommendation

Congratulation

Query

Notices

Advertisement

Memoranda

Meeting (minutes) etc.

D COMPREHENSION AND INTERPRETATION

Q26 What is Comprehension?

ANS:

Comprehension means understanding what is read. The ability to understand and get meaning from spoken and written language. It is primarily aimed to acquire knowledge and apply it appropriately in context.

Q27 Explain interpretation in relation to a passage.

ANS:

Interpretation deals with how you digest what you read. What really shows that you understand the content of a text is your ability to restate the information therein from your own perspective. This shows you must be able to interpret and explain in your own words without doing any damage to the text.